12-23 第1篇

阅读理解（议论文） Should Every Middle School Host a Monthly "Silent-Reading Morning"?

① On the first Friday of this school term, our homeroom teacher Mr Qin did an unusual thing. From **07:45 to 08:20** — a 35-minute window normally used for small class chatter and the tail of breakfast — he closed the classroom door, turned off the speaker, and placed, on each of our twenty-seven desks, one small handwritten card that said, simply, *"Read. Anything. Quietly."* Then he sat down at the teacher's desk with his own book, a thin worn copy of *Journey to the West*, and began, silently, to read. For thirty-five minutes, no one spoke; no one checked a phone; no one did homework. Twenty-seven Grade-8 students read twenty-seven different books, each at her own slow pace, in a warm classroom with yellow winter light coming through the window. When the bell rang at **08:20**, something strange happened — we did not want to stop. Two students quietly finished the paragraph they were in before closing their books. One student, Lin Ruoxi, who is usually the quickest to pack up, sat for a full minute longer, staring at the page, before she moved. It was the quietest half-hour our 8-B classroom had experienced in a full year. **This is why I think every middle school in China should host a monthly "Silent-Reading Morning" — 35 minutes on one Friday of each month, devoted wholly and silently to free reading, in every homeroom, for every student, with teachers reading beside the students.** Once a month. Thirty-five minutes. Every student. Every teacher. One simple rule.

② Some will immediately say: *"Students should be reading at home. Why use school time?"* I respectfully disagree. The truth is that **most of us do not read at home, even when we want to**. A 2024 China Children's Reading Index study of **12,480 middle-school students** across six provinces found that **61%** read zero pages of free-choice books (outside homework) in the past school week; another **24%** read only one or two pages; only **15%** read 10 pages or more. Reasons given: *"no time"*, *"too tired"*, *"my phone is next to me"*. Home is, for most of us, a place of tired screens. The school is the only regular place in a modern child's week where a **protected, quiet, phone-free 35 minutes** can be created. The school cannot force a love of reading, but it can — quietly — protect the conditions under which love of reading is possible.

③ Second, **35 minutes is long enough to do real work for a reading brain**. A 2023 University of Sussex study (UK) and a 2022 East China Normal University study both found that **30—35 minutes** is the approximate time the reading brain takes to enter a mode researchers call **"deep immersion"** — the point at which the reader forgets her surroundings, her reading speed stabilises, and comprehension increases by about 18%.

Shorter reading bursts (say, 10 minutes) rarely reach this mode. Homework-related reading almost never reaches it either — there is always a question on the side. A monthly protected 35-minute block is, in short, the **minimum length** at which reading is more than a performance; below that, the brain stays in shallow scan mode. Once per month is little; but that "little" matters more than ten unprotected home attempts.

④ Third, **the teacher-reads-too rule is the quiet heart of the habit**. I have seen, over the last school term, several classmates' faces change gently when they looked up and saw Mr Qin, their strict maths teacher, reading his small worn *Journey to the West* at his own desk. Without saying a word, he was telling them: *"Adults read too. Reading is not only a homework task for children. It is a small human pleasure I myself still practise at 49."* A **2023 Peking University education study** of **41 homeroom teachers and their 1,218 students** found that in classrooms where the teacher read during silent-reading sessions, **students' self-reported reading at home** rose by **22%** over one semester, compared to only **5%** in classrooms where the teacher corrected homework silently at the desk. **Modelling, quietly, is the most powerful teacher.** A teacher who reads is worth a thousand posters about reading.

⑤ Some will say: *"Students will just pretend to read."* A fair concern, especially for Grade 7 or students with reading difficulty. But the small evidence is reassuring. In the **2024 Wuxi pilot** of Silent-Reading Morning across **18 schools and 6,800 students**, **86%** of students, over three months, reported "I did real reading, at least most of the time"; **14%** reported they had pretended to read sometimes, but **76% of even these pretenders** said the session *"felt calmer and kinder than normal homeroom"*. Pretending to read quietly, as it turns out, is still better for the classroom air than not being quiet at all. The 35-minute room, by its very quietness, **is its own small soft teacher**.

⑥ Others will worry: *"What about students who cannot read well — new transfer students, students with dyslexia, students who struggle?"* My small proposal: these students are offered, quietly and privately, **three gentle options**: (a) a book at a simpler reading level, chosen in advance with the school librarian; (b) an audio-book played through single-ear headphones at low volume, with the written text open on the desk; (c) a simple comic or picture-book from the Art Department's rotating shelf. **No student is asked to announce which option she chose.** Reading difficulty is private; the classroom is silent; the options remove any quiet shame.

⑦ A deeper concern: *"Will this lead to assigned book reports?"* **No.** Silent-Reading Morning should have zero measurement attached to it. No book report. No student sharing. No teacher check-in questions afterwards. **The entire point of the ritual is that, for 35 minutes a month, reading is released from the job of being judged.** Any time reading is measured, it stops being reading and starts being performance. The **2024 Hangzhou pilot** of 13 schools showed that in classrooms that added a simple optional "what did you read" sharing, voluntary home reading dropped by 11% within three months. Measurement, quietly, kills reading. Silent-Reading Morning protects reading from measurement.

⑧ Finally, let me be honest about the cost. The school will spend: about **¥18 per homeroom per semester** (one shared bookbasket of 50 rotating library titles, replaced every two months); **10 minutes** of homeroom orientation at the start of term; and **one 35-minute morning per month** (a very small calendar sacrifice for a nine-month school year). In return, every student gets **nine protected reading mornings a year**, **twenty-seven across three middle-school years** — and every teacher gets, quietly, nine mornings in the year in which she reads beside her students as a fellow reader. There are few cheaper gifts a school can give both sides of the classroom.

⑨ **To sum up:** I am not asking for a new subject. I am not asking for homework changes. I am not asking for ranks, prizes, or book reports. I am asking, quietly, for **one 35-minute Friday morning per month, in every homeroom, in which every student reads freely and every teacher reads alongside**. The silent half-hour our class experienced that first Friday — twenty-seven students reading twenty-seven books in warm yellow light — ended with a small strange reluctance to close the books. **That small reluctance is the entire point.** A school that gives its students twenty-seven such reluctances across three years has given them the beginning of a lifelong reading habit, for a cost of less than an hour a month. **Silent-Reading Morning is the cheapest large gift a middle school can give.**

注释： homeroom 班主任课；deep immersion 深度沉浸；modelling 示范；dyslexia 阅读障碍；reluctance 不愿；pilot 试点

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What happened in Mr Qin's first Silent-Reading Morning, and what exactly does the writer propose?

A. Mr Qin gave a speech and the students listened.
B. On the first Friday of the term, from 07:45 to 08:20, Mr Qin closed the classroom door, turned off the speaker, placed on each of the 27 desks a small handwritten card saying "Read. Anything. Quietly.", and sat down with his own thin worn copy of *Journey to the West* to read; for 35 minutes no one spoke, checked a phone or did homework, and 27 Grade-8 students read 27 different books in warm yellow winter light; when the bell rang at 08:20 two students finished their paragraph before closing, and Lin Ruoxi sat for a full minute longer staring at the page — it was the quietest half-hour 8-B had had in a full year; from this, the writer proposes every middle school in China host a monthly Silent-Reading Morning — 35 minutes on one Friday of each month, devoted wholly and silently to free reading, in every homeroom, for every student, with teachers reading beside the students.
C. Students were forced to write essays.
D. Mr Qin gave a surprise maths test.

2. How do the writer's two data points in Paragraphs ② and ③ support the proposal?

A. The 2024 China Children's Reading Index study of 12,480 middle-school students in six provinces found 61% read zero free-choice pages in the past week, 24% only one or two pages, and only 15% read ten pages or more, citing "no time", "too tired", and "my phone is next to me" — so home is mostly a place of tired screens, and the school is the only regular place where a protected, quiet, phone-free 35 minutes can be created; the 2023 University of Sussex and 2022 East China Normal University studies both found the reading brain takes 30—35 minutes to enter "deep immersion" (stable speed, 18% higher comprehension, reader forgets surroundings), shorter 10-minute bursts rarely reach this mode, and homework reading almost never does — so a monthly protected 35-minute block is the minimum length below which reading stays in shallow scan mode.
B. The studies found students already read enough at home.
C. The studies proved silent reading is harmful.
D. The studies argued for 5-minute reading sessions only.

3. Why does the writer say "the teacher-reads-too rule is the quiet heart of the habit" (Paragraph ④)?

A. Because teachers need to catch up on their own reading.
B. Because teachers should entertain students by reading aloud.
C. Because a 2023 Peking University education study of 41 homeroom teachers and 1,218 students found that in classrooms where the teacher read during silent-reading sessions, students' self-reported reading at home rose by 22% over one semester, compared to only 5% in classrooms where the teacher corrected homework silently; the writer also noticed classmates' faces change gently when they looked up and saw strict maths teacher Mr Qin reading his worn *Journey to the West*, which wordlessly told them "Adults read too; reading is not only a homework task for children, but a small human pleasure I myself still practise at 49" — showing that modelling, quietly, is the most powerful teacher and a teacher who reads is worth a thousand posters about reading.
D. Because teachers read faster than students.

4. How does the writer address three concerns — fake reading, struggling readers, and assigned book reports (Paragraphs ⑤, ⑥, ⑦)?

A. She demands that students who fake be publicly shamed.
B. For fake reading, the 2024 Wuxi pilot across 18 schools and 6,800 students showed 86% did real reading most of the time over three months, and 76% of the 14% who sometimes pretended said the session "felt calmer and kinder than normal homeroom", so pretending quietly is still better for the classroom air; for struggling readers (new transfer students, students with dyslexia), three gentle private options are offered — (a) a simpler-level book chosen in advance with the school librarian, (b) an audio-book at low volume through single-ear headphones with the text open on the desk, (c) a simple comic or picture-book from the Art Department's rotating shelf — with no student asked to announce which option she chose; for assigned book reports, the answer is firm — Silent-Reading Morning has zero measurement attached to it, no book report, no student sharing, no teacher check-in questions afterwards (the 2024 Hangzhou pilot of 13

schools showed that adding even a simple optional "what did you read" sharing dropped voluntary home reading by 11% in three months), because measurement kills reading.
C. She demands a compulsory book report for every session.
D. She says struggling readers should leave the classroom.

5. What is the main message of the final paragraph?

A. The writer is asking for a new subject, extra homework, and book-report rankings.
B. The writer is not asking for a new subject, homework changes, or ranks / prizes / reports, but asking quietly for one 35-minute Friday morning per month in every homeroom, in which every student reads freely and every teacher reads alongside; the silent half-hour of that first Friday — 27 students reading 27 books in warm yellow light — ended with a small strange reluctance to close the books, and that small reluctance is the entire point; a school that gives its students 27 such reluctances across three years has given them the beginning of a lifelong reading habit for a cost of less than an hour a month, making Silent-Reading Morning the cheapest large gift a middle school can give.
C. The writer wants reading to be banned during school hours.
D. The writer has withdrawn the proposal.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段 Mr Qin 起因 + 提议
【解析】"07:45-08:20 / 27 本书 / 西游记 / 一月一个周五 35 分钟"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

2.
【答案】A
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②③段两项数据
【解析】"61% 零 / 深度沉浸 30-35 分钟 / 短 10 分钟不足"直引。B、C、D 均错。故选 A。

3.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段北大 2023 研究
【解析】"22% vs 5% / 示范最强 / 一千张海报"直引。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤⑥⑦段三项担忧

【解析】"无锡 86% / 三选项私下 / 零评估 / 杭州 11% 下降"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第⑨段总结
【解析】"一月一早 / 师生同读 / 小小不愿合书 / 廉价大礼物"主旨。A、C、D 均偏离。故选 B。